Contracts and Procurement at PPS



PORTLAND
Public Schools

September 30, 2025

Overview

Goal:

To provide the Board with a concise overview of PPS's procurement framework, ensuring transparency, efficiency, and compliance.

Key Topics:

☑ Guiding principles and authority

☑ Procurement methods and dollar thresholds

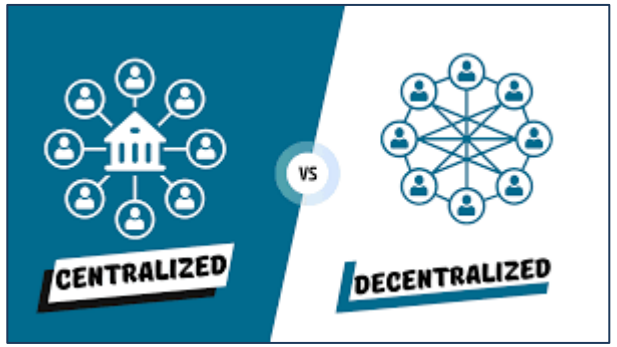
☑ Contract review and approval process

☑ The Board's specific role



Governing Rules

All activities adhere to the PPS Public Contracting Rules, Oregon Revised Statutes, and Federal Procurement Guidelines.



Centralized & Decentralized

Procurement is a partnership between the central Purchasing & Contracting Department and individual schools/departments.



Ethical Foundation

We are committed to transparency, competitive processes, and responsible use of public funds.

Procurement Thresholds

The dollar amount of a purchase or contract dictates the required level of competition.

Under $25,000* (Micropurchase)

Competition encouraged but not required.

$25,000-$250,000* (Intermediate)

Requires a minimum of three quotes or proposals. Board approval is needed for purchases over $150,000.

Over $250,000* (Formal)

Requires a formal, publicly advertised solicitation process (Request for Proposals or Invitation to Bid).

*For Personal Services contracts, no competition is required for contracts $75,000 and below. For Construction projects, contracts above $100,000 require a formal procurement process

Formal Procurements

- **Invitation to Bid (ITB):**
  - Used for acquiring **goods** and **construction projects** based on detailed specifications.
  - Awarded to the lowest responsive and responsible bidder.
- **Request for Proposals (RFP):**
  - Used for **complex services, personal services, material requirements, and certain construction projects**.
  - Scoring is based on evaluation criteria including qualifications, approach, and price.



Exceptions to Competitive Bidding

Certain situations allow for non-competitive procurement.

Cooperative Purchasing:

State procurement statutes allow piggybacking on an existing contract formally solicited by another public entity.

Direct Negotiation:

Board-approved rules allowing procurement without competition of personal services that require specialized skills and expertise (e.g., legal or audit services, sports officiation, medical services)

Emergency Procurements

Sole-Source Procurement:

A contract is awarded directly to a single vendor if they are the only source for the product or service.

Special Class Procurements:

Board-approved rules allowing procurement without competition of goods and services in specific situations (e.g., curriculum materials and software/digital resources available from only one source)

Contract Review and Approval

Procurement Process	Contract Initiation	Contract Intake
Competitive procurement process (Quotes, Request for Proposals, Invitation to Bid) if required	**School or department** initiates contract negotiation, completes contract using District templates, and submits to Purchasing & Contracting department for review and approval	**Contracts team** reviews for proper documents, budget holder approval, completion of contracts training course, vendor setup

Contract Review and Approval (cont.)

Contract Analyst Review	Contract Signer Review	Contract Recordkeeping
Contract Analyst reviews for procurement and policy compliance, required scope and exhibits, appropriate dates, etc.	**Authorized Contract Signer** final review and signature (or, for contracts over $150,000, submission to **Board** for approval before signature)	**Contracts team** ensures contract management system record is complete, sends out final signed contract to all parties

The Board's Role



Contract Approval

The Board approves contracts and purchase orders that exceed specified dollar thresholds or require special exemptions.

Rule Adoption

The Board must approve any updates or changes to the **PPS Public Contracting Rules.**



Strategic Oversight

The Board ensures that procurement activities align with the district's broader goals.

The Board provides key oversight for the district's contracts and procurement.

Summary and Questions

Summary: We have a clear and established framework for procurement that balances efficiency, compliance, and transparency. The Board's role is critical in providing oversight and approval for significant purchases and policy changes.

Questions?

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